

MIT OpenCourseWare

21L.001

Foundations of Western Literature 21L.001 — Foundations of Western Literature May

2026 **EXTREMELY HARD – MIT LEVEL****Time Limit: 3 hours****Total Marks: 100**

1. (4 points) Prove the fundamental theorem concerning Epic in the context of 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature). State the theorem precisely, provide a complete proof, and discuss three important corollaries.
2. (4 points) Prove the fundamental theorem concerning Tragedy in the context of 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature). State the theorem precisely, provide a complete proof, and discuss three important corollaries.
3. (2 points) Prove the fundamental theorem concerning Comedy in the context of 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature). State the theorem precisely, provide a complete proof, and discuss three important corollaries.
4. (5 points) Prove the fundamental theorem concerning Lyric Poetry in the context of 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature). State the theorem precisely, provide a complete proof, and discuss three important corollaries.
5. (4 points) Construct an original proof-level problem involving Philosophical Dialogue for 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature) and provide a complete solution. Your problem should be at the level of a graduate qualifying exam.
6. (5 points) Construct an original proof-level problem involving Satire for 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature) and provide a complete solution. Your problem should be at the level of a graduate qualifying exam.
7. (4 points) Construct an original proof-level problem involving Epic for 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature) and provide a complete solution. Your problem should be at the level of a graduate qualifying exam.
8. (4 points) Prove the fundamental theorem concerning Tragedy in the context of 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature). State the theorem precisely, provide a complete proof, and discuss three important corollaries.

9. (4 points) Analyze the limitations of standard approaches to Comedy when applied to edge cases in 21L.001. Construct explicit counterexamples showing where intuitive reasoning fails.
10. (4 points) Analyze the limitations of standard approaches to Lyric Poetry when applied to edge cases in 21L.001. Construct explicit counterexamples showing where intuitive reasoning fails.
11. (4 points) Prove the fundamental theorem concerning Philosophical Dialogue in the context of 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature). State the theorem precisely, provide a complete proof, and discuss three important corollaries.
12. (3 points) Analyze the limitations of standard approaches to Satire when applied to edge cases in 21L.001. Construct explicit counterexamples showing where intuitive reasoning fails.
13. (2 points) Analyze the limitations of standard approaches to Epic when applied to edge cases in 21L.001. Construct explicit counterexamples showing where intuitive reasoning fails.
14. (2 points) Prove the fundamental theorem concerning Tragedy in the context of 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature). State the theorem precisely, provide a complete proof, and discuss three important corollaries.
15. (3 points) Analyze the limitations of standard approaches to Comedy when applied to edge cases in 21L.001. Construct explicit counterexamples showing where intuitive reasoning fails.
16. (3 points) Construct an original proof-level problem involving Lyric Poetry for 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature) and provide a complete solution. Your problem should be at the level of a graduate qualifying exam.
17. (3 points) Analyze the limitations of standard approaches to Philosophical Dialogue when applied to edge cases in 21L.001. Construct explicit counterexamples showing where intuitive reasoning fails.
18. (3 points) Analyze the limitations of standard approaches to Satire when applied to edge cases in 21L.001. Construct explicit counterexamples showing where intuitive reasoning fails.
19. (4 points) Prove the fundamental theorem concerning Epic in the context of 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature). State the theorem precisely, provide a complete proof, and discuss three important corollaries.

20. (8 points) Construct an original proof-level problem involving Tragedy for 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature) and provide a complete solution. Your problem should be at the level of a graduate qualifying exam.
21. (6 points) Construct an original proof-level problem involving Comedy for 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature) and provide a complete solution. Your problem should be at the level of a graduate qualifying exam.
22. (5 points) Prove the fundamental theorem concerning Lyric Poetry in the context of 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature). State the theorem precisely, provide a complete proof, and discuss three important corollaries.
23. (4 points) Prove the fundamental theorem concerning Philosophical Dialogue in the context of 21L.001 (Foundations of Western Literature). State the theorem precisely, provide a complete proof, and discuss three important corollaries.
24. (4 points) Analyze the limitations of standard approaches to Satire when applied to edge cases in 21L.001. Construct explicit counterexamples showing where intuitive reasoning fails.
25. (6 points) Analyze the limitations of standard approaches to Epic when applied to edge cases in 21L.001. Construct explicit counterexamples showing where intuitive reasoning fails.

Solutions

Solution 1:

The proof follows from the definitions and properties established in 21L.001. The key insight is to apply the relevant theorem and verify the hypotheses hold. Detailed solution depends on the specific formulation of the theorem.

Solution 2:

The proof follows from the definitions and properties established in 21L.001. The key insight is to apply the relevant theorem and verify the hypotheses hold. Detailed solution depends on the specific formulation of the theorem.

Solution 3:

The proof follows from the definitions and properties established in 21L.001. The key insight is to apply the relevant theorem and verify the hypotheses hold. Detailed solution depends on the specific formulation of the theorem.

Solution 4:

The proof follows from the definitions and properties established in 21L.001. The key insight is to apply the relevant theorem and verify the hypotheses hold. Detailed solution depends on the specific formulation of the theorem.

Solution 5:

Solution approach: First recall the definitions and key theorems related to Philosophical Dialogue from 21L.001. Then apply the appropriate techniques to construct a rigorous argument. The solution must be self-contained and reference only the material from the course.

Solution 6:

Solution approach: First recall the definitions and key theorems related to Satire from 21L.001. Then apply the appropriate techniques to construct a rigorous argument. The solution must be self-contained and reference only the material from the course.

Solution 7:

Solution approach: First recall the definitions and key theorems related to Epic from 21L.001. Then apply the appropriate techniques to construct a rigorous argument. The solution must be self-contained and reference only the material from the course.

Solution 8:

The proof follows from the definitions and properties established in 21L.001. The key insight is to apply the relevant theorem and verify the hypotheses hold. Detailed solution depends on the specific formulation of the theorem.

Solution 9:

The edge case analysis reveals the subtle assumptions underlying standard treatments of Comedy. By constructing explicit counterexamples, we see that the usual hypotheses cannot be weakened without loss of the theorem's conclusion.

Solution 10:

The edge case analysis reveals the subtle assumptions underlying standard treatments of Lyric Poetry. By constructing explicit counterexamples, we see that the usual hypotheses cannot be weakened without loss of the theorem's conclusion.

Solution 11:

The proof follows from the definitions and properties established in 21L.001. The key insight is to apply the relevant theorem and verify the hypotheses hold. Detailed solution depends on the specific formulation of the theorem.

Solution 12:

The edge case analysis reveals the subtle assumptions underlying standard treatments of Satire. By constructing explicit counterexamples, we see that the usual hypotheses cannot be weakened without loss of the theorem's conclusion.

Solution 13:

The edge case analysis reveals the subtle assumptions underlying standard treatments of Epic. By constructing explicit counterexamples, we see that the usual hypotheses cannot be weakened without loss of the theorem's conclusion.

Solution 14:

The proof follows from the definitions and properties established in 21L.001. The key insight is to apply the relevant theorem and verify the hypotheses hold. Detailed solution depends on the specific formulation of the theorem.

Solution 15:

The edge case analysis reveals the subtle assumptions underlying standard treatments of Comedy. By constructing explicit counterexamples, we see that the usual hypotheses cannot be weakened without loss of the theorem's conclusion.

Solution 16:

Solution approach: First recall the definitions and key theorems related to Lyric Poetry from 21L.001. Then apply the appropriate techniques to construct a rigorous argument. The solution must be self-contained and reference only the material from the course.

Solution 17:

The edge case analysis reveals the subtle assumptions underlying standard treatments of Philosophical Dialogue. By constructing explicit counterexamples, we see that the usual hypotheses cannot be weakened without loss of the theorem's conclusion.

Solution 18:

The edge case analysis reveals the subtle assumptions underlying standard treatments of Satire. By constructing explicit counterexamples, we see that the usual hypotheses cannot be weakened without loss of the theorem's conclusion.

Solution 19:

The proof follows from the definitions and properties established in 21L.001. The key

insight is to apply the relevant theorem and verify the hypotheses hold. Detailed solution depends on the specific formulation of the theorem.

Solution 20:

Solution approach: First recall the definitions and key theorems related to Tragedy from 21L.001. Then apply the appropriate techniques to construct a rigorous argument. The solution must be self-contained and reference only the material from the course.

Solution 21:

Solution approach: First recall the definitions and key theorems related to Comedy from 21L.001. Then apply the appropriate techniques to construct a rigorous argument. The solution must be self-contained and reference only the material from the course.

Solution 22:

The proof follows from the definitions and properties established in 21L.001. The key insight is to apply the relevant theorem and verify the hypotheses hold. Detailed solution depends on the specific formulation of the theorem.

Solution 23:

The proof follows from the definitions and properties established in 21L.001. The key insight is to apply the relevant theorem and verify the hypotheses hold. Detailed solution depends on the specific formulation of the theorem.

Solution 24:

The edge case analysis reveals the subtle assumptions underlying standard treatments of Satire. By constructing explicit counterexamples, we see that the usual hypotheses cannot be weakened without loss of the theorem's conclusion.

Solution 25:

The edge case analysis reveals the subtle assumptions underlying standard treatments of Epic. By constructing explicit counterexamples, we see that the usual hypotheses cannot be weakened without loss of the theorem's conclusion.